

EDUCATION

- 2021–2027 **Ph.D. in Economics**, *University of California, Berkeley*
(expected) ◦ Fields: Development Economics, Political Economy (Designated Emphasis)
- 2018–2020 **M.Sc. in Economics (2 Year)**, *London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)*
◦ Jointly awarded **Sir John Hicks Prize** for best overall performance
- 2014–2017 **B.A. in International Relations**, *Technische Universität Dresden*, GPA: 4.0 equiv.
◦ Exchange semester at *Université de la Réunion*, France.
◦ Volker-Heinsberg-Award for best bachelor thesis in 2017.

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

Screening for Collusion in Public Procurement: *Evidence from 5 Million Auctions in India*

- Bidder collusion inflates the cost of public procurement, which accounts for close to a third of government spending in developing countries, yet its prevalence remains largely unmeasured where enforcement is weak. Using the near-universe of electronically tendered Indian public contracts – more than five million contracts since 2008 – I build a pair-level screen from warning signals the Competition Commission of India instructs procuring officers to watch for. Collusion is diffuse and affects almost half of all contracts. Colluding firms target thin markets and extract higher prices than non-colluding firms. A structural estimation of firms' costs implies sizable savings from competitive pricing.

Work in Progress

Pacifying Effects of Minority Political Representation: Evidence from India

- Mandated political representation for low-caste groups in India decreased conflict from insurgency by 5-10% and reduced crime against lower castes.

Hidden Campaign Finance: Evidence from India (with Amol Singh Raswan)

- Firms exploit anonymous donation channels, giving to parties other than those in their publicly disclosed portfolio.

Building Minds: Evidence from a School-Based Cognitive Enrichment Intervention in Kenya (with Uyanga Byambaa)

- A randomized seven-week school chess program in Kenya raises multiple dimensions of cognitive ability and benefits students that were weaker at baseline.

Publications

"Healthy ageing trends in England between 2002 to 2018 : Improving but slowing and unequal". With Andrew J. Scott. *The Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, Vol. 26, 100470. 2023.

"Cycles of Fire: Politics and Forest Burning in Indonesia". With Clare Balboni, Robin Burgess, Anton Heil, and Ben Olken. *AEA Papers & Proceedings* 111: 415-419. 2021.

"Democracy and the transnational dimensions of low-level conflict and state repression". With Martin Rößler and Patrick Zwerschke. *International Studies Quarterly* 65 (3): 753–767. 2021.

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

- Summer 2025 **Summer Associate, Cornerstone Research** (San Francisco)
◦ Economic consulting; analysis in support of litigation and regulatory matters
- Fall 2023–2025 **RA for Francesco Trebbi** (UC Berkeley)
◦ Work on structural estimation of political economy models

- Summer **RA for Ted Miguel** (UC Berkeley)
2022 ◦ Meta-analysis project on climate change and conflict, field project on refugees in Jordan
- 2020–2021 **Predoc for Oriana Bandiera and Robin Burgess** (LSE)
◦ Projects in political economy, development/organizational/environmental economics
- 2017–2018 **Intern and RA at ifo Institute for Economic Research** (Dresden)
◦ Policy-related economic research on housing prices & immigration, fiscal policy, education

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- CEGA Grant for field work on blood donations in India, 2022 (US\$4,500)
- DAAD Graduate Scholarship for 2018–2020 (€32,000)
- German National Academic Foundation, 2014–2020 (€45,000)

WORKSHOPS AND PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 **Lindau:** Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting on Economic Sciences, Lindau, Germany
Banff: Empirical Microeconomics Workshop, Banff, Canada
- 2024 **SASE:** Annual Conference of SASE, Limerick, Ireland
- 2023 **TU Dresden:** German Development Economics Conference
- 2021 **UC Berkeley:** Political Economy Conference, Poster presentation
- 2019 **ISA Toronto:** Annual Convention of International Studies Association
Uni Münster: Political Economy of Democracy and Dictatorship
- 2017 **CESifo:** Discussant, 11th Workshop on Political Economy

TEACHING

- 2022–2026 **Graduate Student Instructor, Econ 140 (Econometrics)**, UC Berkeley
◦ Outstanding GSI Award for teaching in Fall 2022 and Spring 2023
◦ Materials and course evaluations on [my teaching website](#)
- 2018–2024 **Guest Lecturer, Introduction to Interdisciplinary Research** (TU Dresden)

REFEREEING

Econometrica

PERSONAL

- **Languages:** German (native), English, French, Hindi (intermediate)
- **Citizenship:** Germany. US Permanent Resident. Overseas Citizen of India.

REFERENCES

- Edward Miguel, emiguel@berkeley.edu, *University of California, Berkeley, USA*
- Francesco Trebbi, ftrebbi@berkeley.edu, *Haas School of Business, UC Berkeley, USA*
- Frederico Finan, ffinan@berkeley.edu, *University of California, Berkeley, USA*